

This comprehensive Student Handbook structure is fully compliant with the **Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU) Choice Based Credit System (CBCS) and Outcome Based Education (OBE) Regulations**. It is formatted as an extensive, professional multi-page manual using exact regulatory structures, credit limits, calculation metrics, and institutional guidelines.

VISVESVARAYA TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY

ACADEMIC & INSTITUTIONAL STUDENT HANDBOOK

SECTION 1: PREAMBLE & GENERAL INFORMATION

1.1 Introduction to the University & Institutional Framework

Welcome to the Academic Community. This Handbook serves as the definitive manual governing your academic roadmap, ethical obligations, operational responsibilities, and structural constraints during your tenure here.

All technical programs offered by this Institute are structurally aligned with **Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU), Belagavi**, and are engineered in strict compliance with the **National Education Policy (NEP)** guidelines, the **University Grants Commission (UGC)** parameters, and **AICTE** administrative regulations.

1.2 The Scope of Autonomy and University Affiliation

The institution operates under the academic framework designated by VTU. Depending on whether your specific branch/track operates under an **Autonomous** or **Non-Autonomous Affiliated** status, the administrative distribution of syllabus execution, examination assessment, and grading schedules differs as follows:

- **Curricular Inception:** For autonomous branches, the Boards of Study (BOS) and Academic Council independently design innovative, industry-aligned curricula annually to facilitate accelerated career tracking. Non-autonomous branches follow the centralized baseline frameworks designated by the VTU Belagavi Board of Studies.
- **Degree Conferral:** Irrespective of autonomous status, the final degree certificate is universally formulated, printed, and formally awarded to successful candidates directly by **Visvesvaraya Technological University, Belagavi**.

SECTION 2: THE CHOICE BASED CREDIT SYSTEM (CBCS) & COURSE ARCHITECTURE

2.1 Understanding the Credit Unit

Every course within your curriculum is assigned a specific numeric credit valuation. A "Credit" is an academic metric mapping the precise **weekly instructional workload** required to achieve predefined learning outcomes over a standard 16-week semester.

$$1 \text{ Credit} = \begin{cases} 1 \text{ Hour of Lecture (L) per week} \\ 1 \text{ Hour of Tutorial (T) per week} \\ 2 \text{ Hours of Practical/Laboratory/Field Work (P) per week} \end{cases}$$

2.2 Core Curricular Structural Components

To successfully qualify for graduation, every student must clear a balanced distribution of subjects categorised across five primary pillars:

- **Discipline Specific Core Courses (DSCC):** Foundational, non-negotiable architectural or engineering subjects native to the chosen branch of engineering or application.
- **Professional Elective Courses (PEC):** Domain-specific deep dives allowing specialization tracks within your broad discipline.
- **Open Elective Courses (OEC):** Interdisciplinary exposures enabling engineering students to take certified modules in management, humanities, or alternative technological branches.
- **Non-Credit Mandatory Courses (NCMC):** Critical compliance courses (e.g., Environmental Studies, Constitution of India, Professional Ethics) that carry no numeric impact on your GPA but **must be completed** with satisfying grades to unlock degree validation.
- **Ability Enhancement / Skill Development Courses (AEC):** Focus on hands-on application, technical writing, coding bootcamps, and domain mini-projects.

2.3 Comprehensive 4-Year Credit Load Matrix

The structural distribution of minimum required academic credits across the duration of various programmatic tracks under VTU is outlined below:

Program Architecture & Track	Nominal Duration	Minimum Required Academic Credits
B.E. / B.Tech. Regular Entry (1st Semester)	4 Academic Years	160 Credits
B.E. / B.Tech. Lateral Entry (3rd Semester Diploma)	3 Academic Years	120 Credits
B.E. / B.Tech. with Honors / Minors	4 Academic Years	178 Credits (160 Baseline + 18 Advanced)

Program Architecture & Track	Nominal Duration	Minimum Required Academic Credits
BCA (Honors) Track	4 Academic Years	160 Credits
B.Arch. Track	5 Academic Years	260 Credits

SECTION 3: ATTENDANCE & DURATION LIMITATIONS

3.1 Strict Attendance Compliance Frameworks

Attendance tracking is conducted systematically across individual course modules. Every student must maintain an active, daily documented physical presence in every registered course.

The 85% Absolute Rule: As per VTU Academic Regulations (Clause 15OB 3.1), each semester is viewed as an independent unit. A student must achieve a minimum physical attendance threshold of **85%** in **each individual course** (including both theory lectures and laboratory hours) to qualify for writing the End Semester Examinations.

3.2 Mitigation, Medical Condonation, and Penalties

- **Vice-Chancellor's Condonation Window:** A maximum buffer of **10%** (bringing the baseline down to an absolute floor of **75%**) may be condoned exclusively by the institutional head on behalf of the University. This is applicable **only** under verified medical emergencies (requiring valid registered hospital certification) or official sponsorship for representing the university in national-level sports, technical symposiums, or cultural events.
- **The Non-Eligibility Penalty:** Any student whose calculated attendance in a specific course falls below **75%** (or below 85% without verified condonation documentation) is **automatically disqualified** from sitting for the End Semester Examination (ESE) for that specific course. The student will be awarded an **"N" Grade** (Not Eligible) and must re-register for the entire course from scratch when it is next offered in a subsequent regular or fast-track summer semester.

3.3 Statutory Programmatic Duration Boundaries

Students who struggle to pass their subjects are legally bound by the **Double Nominal Duration Rule** enacted under Section [26] of the VTU Act. The time limits for course completion are strictly enforced:

- **Regular B.E. / B.Tech (4 Years):** Must complete all requirements within a maximum window of **8 consecutive academic years**.
- **Lateral Entry Students (3 Years):** Must clear all structural credits within a maximum window of **6 consecutive academic years**.
- **Failure to Comply:** If a student fails to accumulate all required credits within these statutory limits, their university registration is permanently canceled, and they become ineligible for the degree.

SECTION 4: ASSESSMENT METHODS & CONTINUOUS EVALUATION

The performance tracking architecture breaks down every single credit course into a dual-layered evaluation matrix: **Continuous Internal Evaluation (CIE)** and the **End Semester Examination (ESE)**.

4.1 Continuous Internal Evaluation (CIE) Architecture

CIE constitutes the formative assessment loop managed throughout the semester tenure. It carries a heavy weightage and is non-negotiable.

CIE Step-by-Step Execution Sequence

1.Phase 1: Diagnostic Unit Tests:Weeks 5, 10, and 14.

Students must sit for three mandatory centralized internal tests, each structured out of 20/40 marks. These tests evaluate core conceptual mastery across sequential learning blocks. The average or specified combination of these test scores serves as the baseline for the CIE written component.

2.Phase 2: Continuous Experiential Assessment:Ongoing throughout the semester.

Faculty members issue regular assignments, proctored quizzes, case study submissions, or open-ended technical problem-solving tasks. These activities measure specific Course Outcomes (COs) and account for up to 20% of the overall internal assessment scaling.

3.Phase 3: The Lab Practical Checkpoint:Weekly execution + Final internal lab test.

For integrated or standalone laboratory courses, execution metrics are measured every week. Students are graded based on their actual observation data logs, code functionality checks, engineering drawings, or hardware setups, culminating in a final internal lab examination.

4.Phase 4: Scaling, Verification, and Lock-in:Week 15 (Prior to ESE).

The comprehensive performance logs across tests, assignments, and practicals are compiled out of a total internal pool of 50 marks. Faculty exhibit the evaluated

bluebooks to students for verification. Once approved, the marks are locked into the centralized VTU/Autonomy portal.

4.2 Mandatory CIE Minimum Passing Threshold

Students must actively work to maintain high internal grades throughout the semester.

The 40% CIE Gatekeeper Rule: To be legally permitted to write the End Semester Examination (ESE) for a given course, a student **must secure a minimum of 40% of the total marks allocated to CIE** (i.e., a minimum of 20 out of 50 marks). Any student failing to hit this internal benchmark is blocked from the final exam and will be marked as an automatic course failure.

4.3 End Semester Examination (ESE) Mechanics

- **Structure:** The ESE acts as the final summative evaluation, covering the entire structural expanse of the course syllabus. It is conducted as a proctored, centralized 3-hour examination scaled out of 100 marks and subsequently scaled down to a final value of **50 marks**.
- **Minimum ESE Score:** To pass a subject, a student must secure a minimum score of **40% in the ESE standalone paper** (i.e., 20 out of 50 marks or 40 out of 100 marks on the raw paper).

SECTION 5: GRADING SYSTEMS, SGPA, & CGPA ARCHITECTURE

5.1 The 10-Point Letter Grading Scale

VTU operates on an absolute letter grading schema mapped against a standard 10-point scale. Upon combining the normalized CIE and ESE scores (Total out of 100), students are awarded a designated Letter Grade:

Raw Aggregate Percentage Range	Formally Awarded Letter Grade	Assigned Grade Point (GP) Value	Qualitative Description
≥ 90% up to 100%	O	10.0	Outstanding
≥ 80% up to < 90%	A+	9.5	Excellent
≥ 70% up to < 80%	A	9.0	Very Good

Raw Aggregate Percentage Range	Formally Awarded Letter Grade	Assigned Grade Point (GP) Value	Qualitative Description
≥ 60% up to < 70%	B+	8.0	Good
≥ 55% up to < 60%	B	7.0	Above Average
≥ 50% up to < 55%	C	6.0	Average
≥ 40% up to < 50%	P	5.0	Pass
< 40%	F	0.0	Fail / Backlog

5.2 Mathematical Calculations for SGPA and CGPA

Semester Grade Point Average (SGPA)

The SGPA tracks a student's performance within a single academic semester. It is computed by taking the sum of the total **Credit Points** earned across all registered subjects and dividing it by the sum of the total **Academic Credits** attempted during that specific semester term:

$$SGPA = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n (\text{Course Credits}_i \times \text{Grade Point}_i)}{\sum_{i=1}^n \text{Course Credits}_i}$$

Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA)

The CGPA provides a comprehensive view of a student's overall performance across their entire academic journey up to the current milestone. It is calculated by taking the cumulative sum of all credit points secured since their initial enrollment across all semesters and dividing it by the aggregate number of total credits attempted:

$$CGPA = \frac{\sum_{j=1}^m (\text{Semester Credits}_j \times SGPA_j)}{\sum_{j=1}^m \text{Semester Credits}_j}$$

SECTION 6: MANDATORY AICTE ACTIVITY POINTS PROGRAM (AAPP)

6.1 Operational Rules of the AAPP

In strict accordance with Section 250B of the **VTU (Award of Bachelor of Engineering/Technology Degree) Regulations**, every regular and lateral entry student must earn a set number of non-academic **AICTE Activity Points** to qualify for their final degree certificate.

- **Nature of the Points:** These points do not carry credit weightage and have **zero impact** on your numerical SGPA or CGPA calculations. Instead, they serve as a mandatory check box for graduation readiness.
- **Operational Mechanism:** Points are earned by engaging in community service, rural development projects, sustainable engineering field activities, environmental conservation drives, or traditional NSS/NCC/Sports modules during weekends, holidays, and vacations.

6.2 Points Allocation Matrix & Temporal Limits

The required points target depends on your entry point into the academic program:

Category of Student Admitted	Program Duration	Minimum Activity Points Required
Regular 4-Year B.E. / B.Tech Candidates	4 Years	100 Points (~400 to 450 total engagement hours)
Lateral Entry Candidates (Admitted directly to 3rd Sem)	3 Years	75 Points (~300 to 338 total engagement hours)
Transfer Students (Admitted directly to 5th Sem)	2 Years	50 Points (~200 to 225 total engagement hours)

The Graduation Block: All activity point milestones, along with verified documentary evidence in an official physical activity logbook, **must be completed and certified by institutional advisors prior to the commencement of 8th Semester final examinations**. If a student fails to accumulate these points, their final 8th-semester grade card and degree will be withheld by the University until the deficit is cleared.

SECTION 7: EXAMINATIONS, MALPRACTICE, & VERTICAL PROGRESSION

7.1 Vertical Progression (Year-to-Year Promotion Rules)

To maintain academic eligibility and be permitted to register for higher semesters, VTU enforces specific vertical progression limits regarding maximum permissible backlogs:

- **From 1st Year to 2nd Year:** A student must not carry more than **4 active failing "F" grades** across the combined total of their 1st and 2nd semesters.
- **From 2nd Year to 3rd Year:** A student must have completely cleared all 1st-year (1st and 2nd semester) core academic subjects, alongside maintaining fewer than or equal to 4 backlogs from their 2nd-year coursework.
- **From 3rd Year to 4th Year:** A student must have fully cleared all 2nd-year coursework, with no remaining backlogs from the 3rd or 4th semesters.

7.2 Strict Regulations Against Academic Malpractice

The university maintains a zero-tolerance policy regarding examination misconduct. The following behaviors during internal or external proctored evaluations carry severe institutional penalties:

- **Possession of Unauthorized Material:** Bringing written notes, printed cheat sheets, smartwatches, smartphones, or programmable devices into the examination hall results in the **immediate cancellation of that specific exam paper** and a formal hearing before the Malpractice Inquiry Committee.
- **Impersonation or Copying:** Actively copying from neighboring students or arranging for another person to take an evaluation under your identity will result in the **cancellation of all exams taken during that entire semester session**, coupled with a potential multi-year suspension from the university system.

SECTION 8: ANTI-RAGGING, DISCIPLINARY CODES, & CODE OF CONDUCT

8.1 Statutory Prohibitions Against Ragging

Ragging in any form—physical, psychological, verbal, or digital—is strictly classified as a cognizable criminal offense under the **Karnataka Prohibition of Ragging Act** and the directives of the Supreme Court of India.

- **What Constitutes Ragging:** Any action that causes embarrassment, physical hardship, mental trauma, or personal discomfort to junior students or freshers inside or outside the institutional campus.
- **Punitive Consequences:** Immediate expulsion from the institution, permanent blacklisting on the VTU database, and the immediate filing of a First Information Report (FIR) with local law enforcement agencies, which carries a mandatory minimum prison sentence.

8.2 Institutional General Code of Conduct

- **Campus Identity Protocols:** Every student must visibly wear their official institutional Photo Identity Card at all times while on campus grounds. Security personnel and faculty retain the right to bar entry to anyone without an ID.

- **Digital Responsibility & Asset Safety:** Vandalism or unauthorized handling of laboratory machinery, computer terminals, library resources, or campus property will result in full financial restitution charges and disciplinary action.
- **Substance Prohibition:** The possession, sale, distribution, or consumption of tobacco products, alcohol, or illicit narcotic substances within the campus or hostel boundaries is strictly prohibited. Violations will result in immediate suspension and referral to statutory regulatory authorities.